Yangzhen (Michael) Ye

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RESEARCH PROFILE

Higher education researcher with an M.A. from the University of Michigan specializing in program evaluation, psychometric analysis, and equity-centered student success. Experienced in designing and sustaining longitudinal survey research pipelines, mixed-methods analysis, and producing technical reports for NSF-funded projects. Cross-national research background spanning U.S., Chinese mainland, and Taiwanese higher education contexts. Bilingual in English and Mandarin Chinese.

EDUCATION

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor *Ann Arbor, MI*
M.A. in Higher Education (GPA: 3.87/4.0) *Aug 2024 – Dec 2025*

- Focus: Student Access and Success; Program Evaluation; Quantitative and Qualitative Methods
- Selected Coursework: Non-Experimental Research Methods; Sociology in Higher Ed.; Finance, Management, & Strategy in Higher Ed.; Academic Affairs in Higher Ed.; Power, Privilege, and the Politics of Difference in Higher Ed.

Soochow University *Suzhou, China*
B.A. in Management & B.A. in Education (Double Major, GPA: 3.8/4.0) *Sep 2020 – Jun 2024*

- Exchange Student, Department of Education, University of Taipei (2023–2024)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Associate II *Ann Arbor, MI*
RTMUS Lab, University of Michigan (PI: Dr. Vilma Mesa) *Jan 2025 – Present*

- Independently designed, executed, and maintained the complete analysis pipeline for the PROTEUS Student Survey across two consecutive terms (Fall 2025, $N = 167$; Spring 2026, $N = 465$, the largest Spring cohort in project history); sole-authored both technical reports distributed to NSF and research team stakeholders.
- Established and sustained a longitudinal psychometric framework across terms: conducted exploratory factor analysis (EFA) on the Enjoyment of Mathematics scale in Fall 2025 (3-factor solution; KMO = .86, RMSEA = .095, TLI = .913) and confirmed structural replication in Spring 2026, ensuring cross-term comparability for ongoing program evaluation.
- Integrated quantitative and qualitative methods within a single reporting cycle: multi-group comparisons (four open-source textbooks, 17 institutions), OLS regression (GPA–enjoyment correlation; $r = .31$, $p < .001$), descriptive psychometrics, and systematic thematic coding of open-ended responses ($N = 174$ EOT respondents) independently.
- Conducted qualitative discourse analysis of STAR-team meeting recordings, identifying critical events in which students' epistemic authority shifted and surfacing ecological factors shaping student agency in collaborative problem-solving contexts.
- Collaborated with faculty and cross-institutional stakeholders in the iterative design of novel interactive question formats, improving alignment between student-authored rationales and Runestone platform infrastructure; findings contributed to three academic conference presentations (JMM and RUME 2026).

Assessment Researcher *Ann Arbor, MI*

IGR, University of Michigan (Supervisor: Dr. Christina Morton, Associate Director) *Summer 2025*

- Independently designed an equity-focused evaluation framework for the 2024–25 Common Assessment of Learning, identifying subgroup investigation priorities across identity understanding, bias interruption, and social justice action dimensions.
- Conducted data cleaning and independently replicated descriptive and inferential models from prior institutional assessments to ensure methodological continuity.
- Produced a complete institutional report for senior leadership and external stakeholders; praised by senior staff as one of the best reports in years, with recommendations incorporated into IGR's annual reporting cycle.

Independent Researcher *Ann Arbor, MI*

CSHPE, University of Michigan (Supervisor: Dr. Walter Ecton) *Dec 2024 – Dec 2025*

- Independently designed and executed a theory-driven study examining how student-initiated faculty interactions shape academic achievement, grounded in social and cultural capital frameworks.
- Constructed longitudinal datasets from HSLS:2009 and ELS:2002; applied OLS and stratified regression techniques to test model robustness and examine subgroup heterogeneity across SES and racial categories.
- Accepted to AEFP Annual Meeting (2026); poster presentation.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- **Ye, Y.** (2026). *Beyond Classroom Engagement: How Student-Initiated Faculty Interactions Shape Academic Success*. Poster accepted to the Annual Meeting of the Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP). *(First author; presenter.)*

- Mesa, V., Crandall, J., Kang, Z., & **Ye, Y.** (2026). *Involving Stakeholders in Developing Interactive Questions for PROTEUS Textbooks*. Invited Talk, SIGMAA on RUME Special Session, Joint Mathematics Meetings (JMM).

- Crandall, J., Kang, Z., **Ye, Y.**, & Mesa, V. (2026). *Student Agency in the Collaborative Development of Novel Interactive Textbook Questions in Calculus and Linear Algebra*. Peer-reviewed paper presentation, 28th Conference on Research in Undergraduate Mathematics Education (RUME). *(Contributed to transcript analysis and interpretation of agency-related findings.)*

ADMINISTRATIVE & PROGRAM EXPERIENCE

Program Assistant *Ann Arbor, MI*

LSA Digital Studies Institute (DSI), University of Michigan *Aug 2024 – Aug 2025*

- Coordinated cross-institutional programming between DSI and the DISCO Network, managing event logistics, scheduling, and communications with faculty partners and external institutions.
- Developed and implemented activity workflows from planning through execution, including event promotion, accessibility processes, and post-event documentation.
- Maintained digital archives with rich metadata to institutional accessibility standards, ensuring long-term discoverability of program records.

Peer Mentor & Debate Coach *Suzhou, China*
Soochow University (recognized as Outstanding Student Leader) *May 2021 – Jun 2024*

- Mentored 100+ students across six colleges over three years, providing ongoing academic advising and extracurricular development guidance.
- Served as debate team captain and coach; led the team to competitive inter-university tournaments and supported student leadership development.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Co-curricular Instructor (Invited) *Suzhou, China*
Suzhou Affiliated High School of Xi'an Jiaotong University *Jan 2023 – Jul 2023*

- Designed and taught a full debate curriculum for 30 students, independently developing all lesson materials, instructional content, and weekly training plans.
- Founded the school's first competitive debate team; established a program that continued in subsequent inter-school competitions.

Rural Volunteer Teacher *Puyang, China*
Xvji Wuwei Primary School, Henan Province *Summer 2022*

- Taught at a rural primary school serving students with limited educational resources; gained firsthand insight into educational inequality rooted in cultural and social capital gaps, informing a sustained commitment to equity-centered research and practice.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & METHODS

- **Quantitative Methods:** Exploratory and confirmatory factor analysis (EFA/CFA), OLS and stratified regression, longitudinal data analysis, survey design and scale validation, descriptive and inferential statistics, multi-group comparison
- **Software:** R (ggplot2, lavaan, psych, tidyverse), Stata, Python, Qualtrics, Microsoft Excel; reproducible analysis workflows and publication-quality data visualization
- **Qualitative Methods:** Discourse analysis, transcript coding, critical event analysis, thematic coding of open-ended survey responses
- **Reporting:** Technical report writing for academic and institutional audiences (NSF-funded research; institutional assessment); LaTeX
- **Languages:** English (professional fluency); Mandarin Chinese (native); Traditional Chinese (native level); research experience across U.S., Chinese mainland, and Taiwanese higher education contexts